

Experiment 1

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AIM

To design and analyze a **URL Shortener System** that converts long URLs into short, unique URLs while ensuring high availability, scalability, low latency, and efficient redirection. The system also supports optional custom URLs, expiration dates, and user authentication.

OBJECTIVE:

- To understand functional and non-functional requirements of a large-scale distributed system.
- To design RESTful APIs for URL creation and redirection.
- To identify core entities such as User, Short URL, and Long URL.
- To analyze CAP theorem trade-offs and apply eventual consistency.
- To design high-level and low-level architecture for a scalable URL shortener.
- To study multiple approaches for short URL generation and compare their performance.

TOOLS USED

- **Python** – Backend logic implementation and URL generation algorithms.
- **Flask** – Lightweight web framework for developing RESTful APIs.
- **Draw.io** – Designing system architecture diagrams (HLD & LLD).

SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS:

A. Functional Requirements

- Create a short URL from a given long URL.

- Support optional custom short URLs.
- Support default and user-defined expiration dates.
- Redirect users from short URL to the original long URL.
- Provide REST APIs for URL creation and redirection.
- Support user registration and login using REST APIs.

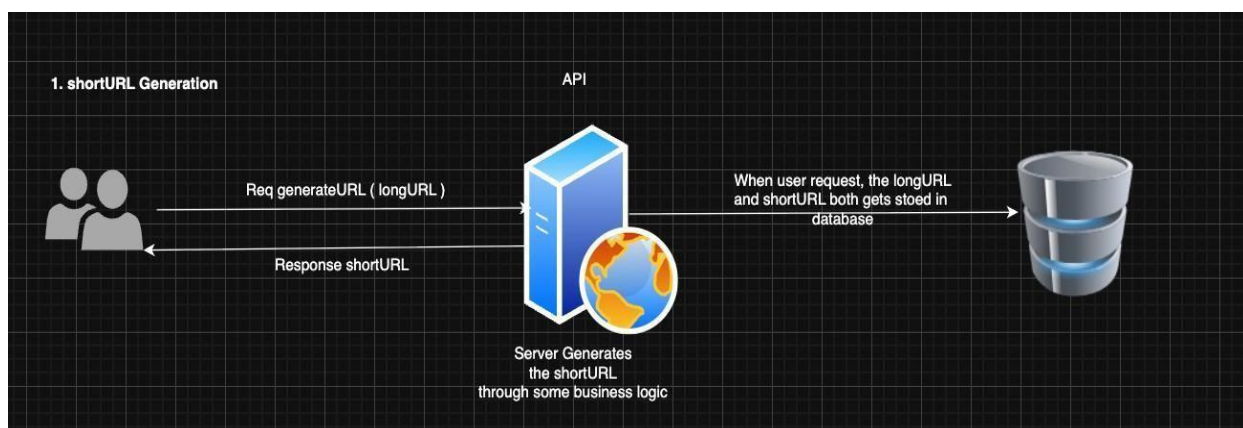
B. Non-Functional Requirements

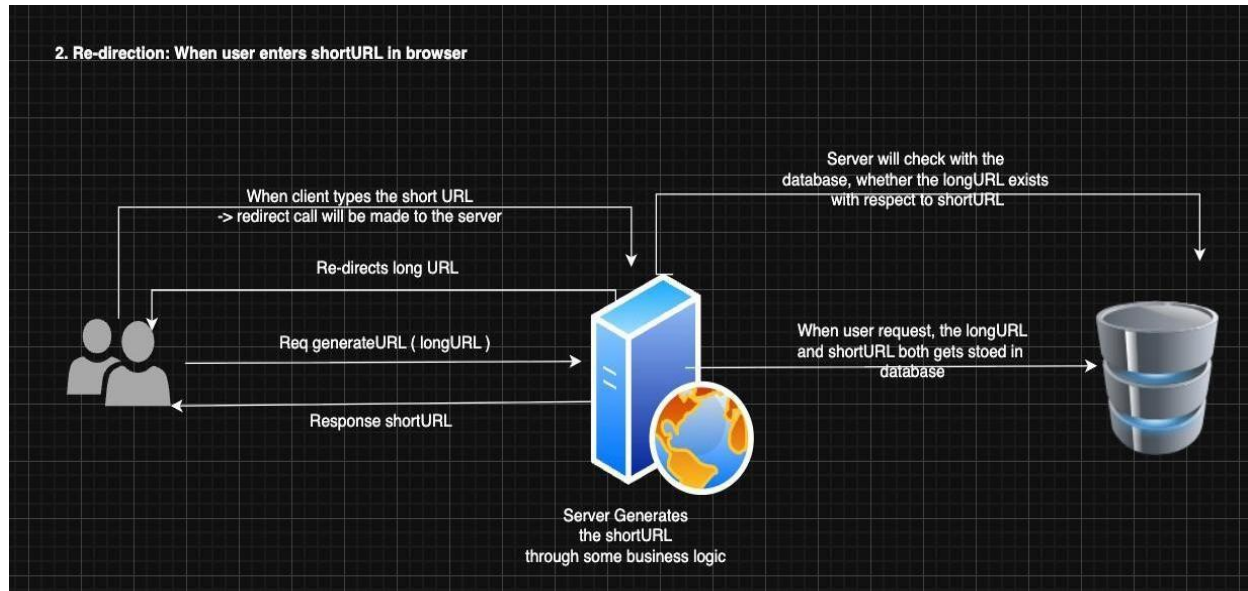
- Low latency (≤ 200 ms for URL creation and redirection).
- High scalability (100M daily active users, 1B URLs).
- High availability (24×7).
- Uniqueness of short URLs.
- High availability preferred over strict consistency (Eventual Consistency).

HIGH LEVEL DESIGN (HLD):

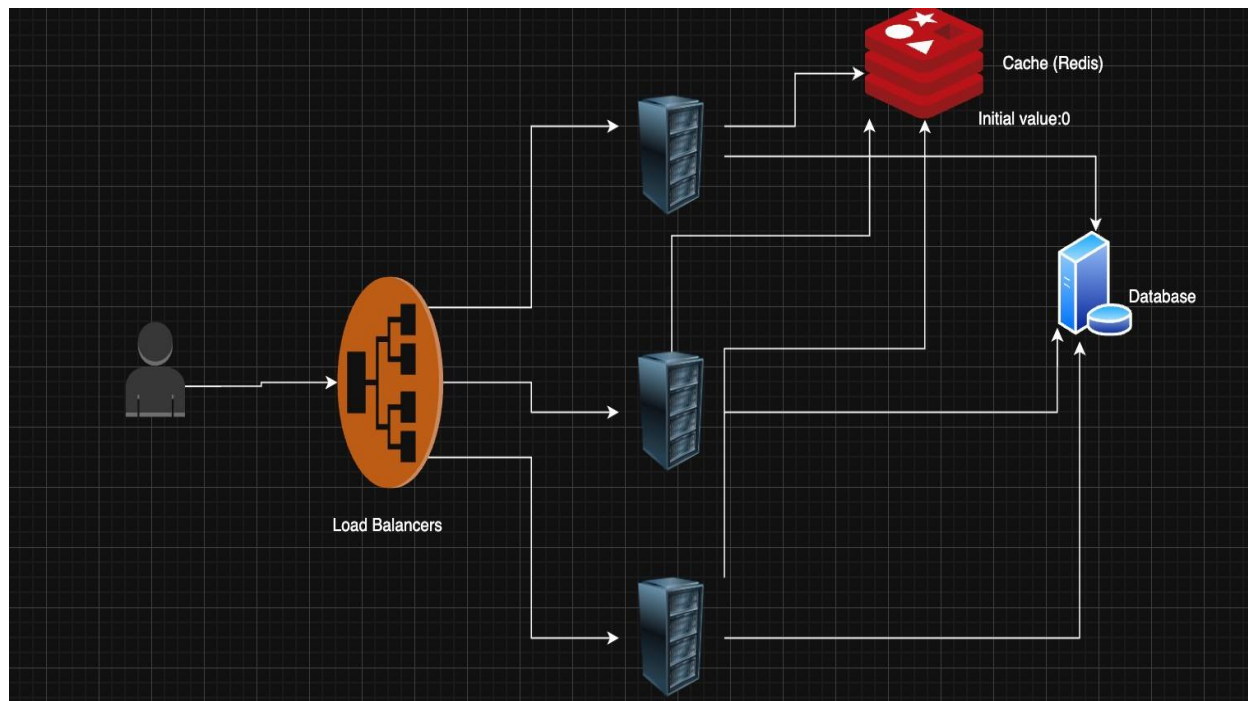
The system follows a **Client–Server–Database architecture**:

- Client sends request to generate or access short URL.
- Server processes business logic and generates short URL.
- Database stores mappings of short URL and long URL.
- On redirection, server fetches long URL and redirects the user.





Final HLD:



LOW LEVEL DESIGN (LLD):

1. Basic URL Shortener

- Generates a new short code every time
- No duplicate checking
- No click tracking
- Uses in-memory dictionary as database
- Very simple & fast
- Same long URL can have multiple different short links
- Data is lost when server restarts

2. URL Shortener with Counter

- Prevents duplicate short URLs
- Tracks number of clicks per link
- Uses two in-memory databases:
 - one for URLs
 - one for click counts
- Provides basic analytics
- Returns existing short link if URL already exists
- Data is lost when server restarts

3. URL Shortener with Duplicate Check

- Guarantees one short link per long URL
- Prevents duplicate entries
- No click tracking
- Cleaner and more predictable behavior
- Uses in-memory dictionary
- Data is lost when server restarts

SCALABILITY SOLUTION

- Horizontal scaling of application servers.
- Use of Load Balancer (Round Robin).
- Centralized counter stored in Redis cache.
- Redis ensures fast access and atomic increments.
- Database stores final URL mappings.



LEARNING OUTCOMES:

- Learned how to design a real-world scalable system.
- Understood REST API design principles.
- Gained knowledge of CAP theorem and eventual consistency.
- Learned multiple URL shortening techniques and their trade-offs.
- Understood horizontal scaling, caching, and load balancing.
- Learned importance of low latency and high availability systems.